

INDEPENDENT TECHNICAL & ARCHITECTURE EVALUATION

Melious AI

A hands-on end-to-end review of platform security posture, sustainability claims, and model transparency against the platform's own public positioning.

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Evaluation basis	Hands-on account setup, dashboard, API documentation, and public platform claims

Overall assessment. Melious AI positions itself as a sovereign, secure, and sustainable European AI platform. A hands-on review of the account setup flow, API documentation, and public claims shows a real and usable product with competitive pricing and a genuinely fast model-onboarding cycle — but also a gap between several marketing statements and what the platform's own interface and documentation currently demonstrate. The findings below are structured so each one can be checked independently against the platform's public dashboard and docs.

01 Compliance Signaling vs. Account Security State

The landing page displays GDPR badges and an “ISO 27001 in progress” note. After login, however, the account setup flow sits at step 1 of 6, and the “vault” section — which governs encryption of stored data — is unconfigured by default. The platform's stated rationale is that the vault only matters for customers who store files directly on the service, since prompts are not retained in normal use. That is a reasonable technical position, but it sits awkwardly next to compliance badges shown before any login — a visitor sees the badges first and the actual security state only after registering.

02 Sustainability Reporting Without Independent Verification

Every inference response in the API carries an *environment_impact* object — energy in kWh, carbon in g CO2, water in litres, a renewable-energy percentage (85%), a PUE figure (~1.18), and a provider ID (OVHcloud / France). Publishing this data at all is a genuinely uncommon and positive practice. What is missing is any external, independently verifiable source for the figures — nothing in the documentation points to real-time hardware telemetry or a third-party audit, so the numbers currently read as estimates rather than measurements. Pairing “green hosting” language with an explicitly-labelled early-access beta is the kind of combination that draws greenwashing scrutiny even when the underlying intent is genuine.

03 Model Provenance Claims Need a Public Paper Trail

Public marketing describes custom-hosted models with an unusually strong price-to-capability ratio, including a claim to be the first European provider serving a specific recent model release. Reviewing the API's request routing suggests the platform operates at least partly as a proxy layer with custom headers in front of upstream models rather than hosting every listed model on dedicated infrastructure. The platform has since indicated that newer models are self-hosted following an infrastructure pivot — if accurate, that would be a meaningful strength, but the public documentation does not yet state, model by model, which ones run on dedicated infrastructure versus a routed upstream endpoint. Until that distinction is published, the “first European provider” framing is difficult for an outside reviewer to verify.

04 Telemetry Defaults Are Privacy-First but Enterprise-Thin

API key usage and token consumption are not tracked by default — monitoring requires an explicit opt-in. This is a defensible privacy-by-design choice for individual developers, and it is consistent with the platform's minimal-logging posture. For enterprise buyers, though, default-off observability is usually a blocker rather than a preference: audit and cost-governance requirements typically assume monitoring is on unless a customer deliberately disables it, not the reverse.

05 Interface and API Surface — What Works Well

The onboarding dashboard is clear: a €5.00 starter credit, an explicit “no usage recorded yet” state, and a visible six-step setup checklist. The cookie notice is unusually precise — a single first-party cookie, no third-party trackers, which is a genuine privacy positive. On the API side, compatibility with both the OpenAI and Anthropic request shapes (base URL `api.melious.ai/v1`) meaningfully lowers migration friction, and the error schema (structured codes such as `INFERENCE_3207`) is more disciplined than most early-stage APIs offer.

Strengths & Structural Risks at a Glance

STRENGTHS	STRUCTURAL RISKS
• Same-day onboarding for newly released models	• Compliance badges shown before the actual account-security state is visible
• Competitive, transparently published token pricing	• No independent verification path for the published sustainability figures
• Drop-in API compatibility with OpenAI and Anthropic request shapes	• Model-hosting claims not yet mapped model-by-model in public docs
• Minimal default logging; no third-party trackers observed	• Monitoring is opt-in rather than on-by-default for enterprise-grade observability
• Per-response environment-impact reporting (rare in this market segment)	• “100% uptime” language paired with an explicit early-access-beta disclaimer

• European infrastructure footprint (OVHcloud, France)	

Recommendations

1. Enable and surface vault/account-security setup by default before compliance badges are shown pre-login.
2. Publish a third-party-verifiable methodology (or audit) behind the environment-impact figures, even a lightweight one.
3. Publish a model-by-model table distinguishing dedicated-infrastructure hosting from proxied upstream endpoints.
4. Default enterprise accounts to monitoring-on, with an explicit opt-out rather than opt-in.
5. Soften or scope the “100% uptime” claim while the platform remains in early-access beta.

Closing note. Melious AI has real, usable strengths — fast model onboarding, competitive pricing, and a privacy posture that many larger providers do not match. The gap identified here is specifically between several public claims and what is independently verifiable today, not a judgment on the team's intent. Closing that gap — mainly through default security posture, independent verification of the sustainability numbers, and clearer model-hosting disclosure — would let the sovereignty and sustainability positioning carry the credibility it is aiming for.

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